



Strengthening the
ecosystem for
sustainable student
mobility

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esiea
PARIS – LAVAL – AGEN

Catalogue of Green Practices

A Sustainable Living Guide for International Students

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to ESIEA!

This Catalogue of Green Practices has been developed within the Erasmus+ [SuMoS](#) (Strengthening the Ecosystem for Sustainable Student Mobility) project to help international students make sustainable choices during their study period at ESIEA. The guide highlights practical actions that contribute to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) while encouraging responsible lifestyles on and off campus.

As a leading French engineering school specializing in digital technologies, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, and software engineering, ESIEA promotes the vision of developing "digital engineering with a purpose." Sustainability, responsible innovation, and ethical use of technology are embedded in the school's culture and educational mission.

ESIEA's campuses, particularly the new eco-responsible campus in Ivry-sur-Seine, demonstrate how innovation and sustainability can work together. Designed using low-carbon and bio-based materials, renewable energy systems, urban agriculture facilities, water recovery systems, and circular economy principles, the campus acts as a living laboratory for sustainable technologies.



–ESIEA's new, eco-responsible campus

Whether you study in Ivry-sur-Seine (Greater Paris) or Laval, your everyday choices can contribute to a more sustainable future.

AWARENESS AND MOTIVATION

Become a Responsible Digital Engineer

Sustainability is not only about recycling and transportation. As a future engineer, you can create positive change through responsible innovation.

One of ESIEA's primary missions is to raise awareness of SDGs and encourage our students to engage in practices that will create a better life for all of us. Practices centered on Sustainability and Social Responsibility, with a focus on Digital Engineering, can be found at all levels on our campuses.

Get involved:

- Take courses at ESIEA designed to raise awareness and align our practices with SDGs:
 - Law and ethics in Cybersecurity
 - AI for Society
 - Human Impact on the Environment
 - Sustainable Business, Corporate Social Responsibility and Digital Sobriety
 - Frugal IoT
- Attend one of our "[2 tons](#)" workshops given at the beginning of each school year, on both campuses, and learn more about how you can make a difference in the fight against climate change.
- Participate in research and innovation activities connected to environmental challenges while completing [a significant technological project](#) during your exchange semester.
- Participate in sustainability-related events and projects such as the [PAIRSE - Project for Societal and Ecological Impact](#), which is part of the core curriculum of the ESIEA engineering program. PAIRSE projects include:
 - Community outreach programs
 - Fun programs in primary schools to get youngsters interested in STEM
 - On-campus workshops to help seniors learn the basics of emailing, sending photos, etc.
 - Events to encourage young women to engage in STEM
- Attend conferences at ESIEA focused on Green IT and sustainable digital technologies.
 - [Conference](#) by [The Shift Project](#), of which ESIEA is an active member.
- Join student clubs working on social, environmental, or technological challenges.

Why it matters

Digital technologies account for a growing share of global energy consumption. As future engineers, ESIEA students have the opportunity and responsibility to develop technologies that are efficient, ethical, and sustainable.

HABITS

TRAVEL -- Move Green

Transportation is often the largest contributor to a student's carbon footprint.

For daily commuting:

- Walk whenever possible.
- Use bicycles or shared bikes.
 - On both our campuses, ESIEA provides secured and sheltered parking for your bicycle.
- Choose public transport rather than driving or using private vehicles (Uber...).
- ✳ Use electric mobility options when available.
- Share rides with fellow students.

Ivry-sur-Seine / Paris

The ESIEA campus is connected to the extensive Paris public transport network:

- Metro
- Bus
- Tramway
- RER suburban trains
 - With the RER C stopping just behind our campus. Very convenient!
 - As a student, you may be eligible for discounts on a monthly public transport subscription. Find out more on the [Mobilité Île de France website](#).

Laval

Laval is a compact city where many destinations are reachable by walking or cycling. Students are encouraged to use local buses, bicycles, and active mobility solutions.

Check out the Laval TUL (Transports Urbains Lavallois) website to find deals for young people under the age of 26 here: [Titres & abonnements | tul-laval](#)

Smart tip: TUL transportation is free on Wednesdays and on the weekend!

For longer trips:

- Prefer trains instead of domestic flights.
- Use buses when practical.
- Combine trips to reduce travel frequency.
- Consider virtual meetings when travel is unnecessary.

LIVING AND ACCOMMODATION

Sustainable Living at Home

Small actions every day can significantly reduce environmental impact.

Save Energy

- Switch off lights when leaving a room.
- Unplug chargers when not in use.
- Reduce unnecessary heating and cooling.
- Use natural light whenever possible.
- Turn electronic devices completely off instead of leaving them on standby.

Save Water

- Take shorter showers.
- Report leaks immediately.
- Turn off taps while brushing your teeth.
- Run washing machines only with full loads.

Responsible Consumption

- Use reusable shopping bags.
 - In France, many shops and grocery stores will not provide any type of bag for you to carry your purchases home with you. Get in the habit of carrying a reusable shopping bag with you.
- Choose durable products.
- Repair items whenever possible instead of replacing them.
- Borrow or share items you use infrequently.

RECYCLING AND WASTE MANAGEMENT

Give Resources a Second Life

Waste reduction starts before recycling.

Remember the 5 Rs:

1. Refuse
2. Reduce
3. Reuse
4. Repair
5. Recycle

At ESIEA

- Bring your electronic devices in need of repair to one of ESIEA's "[repair cafés](#)", organized jointly by the alumni association and one of ESIEA's most active student engineering clubs, [DTRE](#).
- Use the waste sorting facilities available on campus and in student residences.
- Be on the lookout for stations on campus where you can dispose of your dead batteries.

Special tip for engineers

Electronic waste contains valuable materials that can often be recovered and recycled. Never dispose of batteries or electronic devices in regular bins.

The new ESIEA campus even includes facilities dedicated to recycling and circular economy experimentation, including plastic and aluminium recycling activities. Check these out in our Open Labs!

BUYING AND CONSUMPTION

Fashion with Less Impact

Fast fashion creates significant environmental and social impacts.

Better choices:

- Buy fewer, higher-quality clothes.
- Choose second-hand clothing.
- Organize clothing exchanges with friends.
- Repair damaged clothing.
- Support sustainable brands.

Student tip

ESIEA provides opportunities to manage your clothing responsibly.

- On the Laval campus, bins are readily available for you to donate clothing you no longer wear.
- On the Paris campus, in addition to the bins for donations, a “swap meet” is regularly organized for students and staff to bring in clothes and shoes they no longer wear. You can stop by the stand to drop off clothing you no longer use, or to pick out something “new to you”!

Eat Smarter

Food choices matter.

Try to:

- Reduce meat consumption.
- Introduce plant-based meals several times a week.
- Buy seasonal fruits and vegetables.
- Support local producers.
- Avoid food waste.

Easy actions

- Plan meals.
- Store food properly.
- Share surplus food with roommates.
- Bring reusable containers for take-away meals.

Every meal is an opportunity to lower your environmental footprint.

France as a nation is strongly engaged in fighting food waste. One example of an innovative initiative in this domain is the program “[Too Good to Go](#).” Download the app on your phone and find leftovers you can purchase for a very low cost in restaurants, grocery stores, etc. Help protect the environment by bringing your own container, and enjoy wonderful meals without breaking your budget. Everybody wins! We love the use of digital technologies to develop a system that fights food waste.

At ESIEA, we have many microwave ovens available so you can heat up your tasty treats and enjoy a healthy and environmentally responsible lunch.

If you are a “green foodie,” think about getting involved in the urban agriculture projects featured on ESIEA’s campus in Ivry-sur-Seine:

- Help collect honey from the connected beehives on the rooftops of our campus. The beekeepers can monitor the health of the hives using apps developed by ESIEA students, using sensors placed in the hive itself.
- Check out the greenhouse on the roof! This space will be used by urban growers to develop methods of growing fruit and veg on location, to feed local families, so kilometers travelled by produce will be reduced to a minimum.
- Learn about [aquaponics](#), a farming technique that will be put in place in ESIEA’s urban greenhouse. Plants grow in large vats of water filled with fish. The waste from the fish nourishes the plants.



- Plans for a rooftop summer kitchen are in the works!

Reduce Plastic

Single-use plastic creates unnecessary waste.

Simple alternatives:

- Carry a reusable water bottle.
- Bring your own coffee cup.
- Use reusable food containers.
- Avoid disposable cutlery.
- Choose products with minimal packaging.

Good news

France has high-quality drinking water infrastructure, meaning tap water is generally safe and can replace bottled water in most situations.

ESIEA provides high-quality, filtered water in fountains placed strategically throughout our campuses. BYOB!

DIGITAL HABITS

Digital Responsibility Starts Here

As students in digital engineering, your online behaviour also has an environmental impact.

Think Before Printing

Whenever possible:

- Read documents electronically.
- Use shared online files.
- Print only essential documents.
- Print double-sided when necessary.

At ESIEA, it's a no-brainer: you will only be able to print a few pages per semester. All of your course materials will be made available in digital form. Official documents are all signed digitally. No more printing, signing and then scanning to make PDFs!

Clean Up Your Digital Footprint

Data centres consume energy, and digital clutter increases resource use.

Make digital clean-up a habit:

- Delete unnecessary files.
- Remove duplicate photos.
- Unsubscribe from unwanted newsletters.
- Regularly clean cloud storage.
- Use links instead of large email attachments.
- Uninstall unused applications.

Green IT mindset

Efficient code, efficient storage, and responsible digital behaviour contribute to sustainability.

This is particularly relevant for ESIEA students who will help design tomorrow's digital systems, which is why the relationship between digital technologies and SDGs figures prominently in the course offerings at our institution.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Act Together

Sustainability becomes more effective when communities work together.

Get involved:

- Participate in local clean-up events.
- Join environmental student initiatives.
- Volunteer for community projects.
- Take part in sustainability workshops at ESIEA (see above)
- Support social inclusion activities:
 - Teach English to school children in disadvantaged zones (PAIRSE project)
 - Join a group that promotes gender equality in the sciences
 - [Elles Bougent](#)
 - [Femmes Numériques](#)
- Contribute to innovation projects addressing environmental challenges.

At ESIEA

Students are encouraged to engage in collaborative projects, innovation activities, and responsible engineering initiatives that contribute to society and sustainable development.

YOUR SUSTAINABLE STUDENT CHALLENGE

During your stay at ESIEA, try to:

- ☒ Use public transport for most journeys
- ☒ Bring a reusable bottle every day
- ☒ Reduce printing to an absolute minimum
- ☒ Participate in one sustainability-related event
- ☒ Buy at least one second-hand item
- ☒ Reduce food waste
- ☒ Complete one digital clean-up session per month
- ☒ Share sustainable practices with fellow students

Small actions multiplied by hundreds of students can create a significant positive impact.

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